



Google to end app support

Google is planning to gradually phase out Chrome app support on every platform except Chrome OS <http://dgit.in/capend>



Windows 10 blunder

Microsoft in trouble after the anniversary update broke third-party USB webcams <http://dgit.in/mswcfail>

Work@tech

- Video Stitch
- PT GUI
- Adobe Premier Pro

The battlefield

The ways in which VR and AR can be applied are only limited by imagination. While both the fields were trudging on for a long while in the Indian marketplace, recent availability of affordable hardware and smartphones with greater capability have driven the demand for VR and AR content from almost all sectors. According to Mr. Abhishek, "AR was already here for last three years and the adoption was almost static. But major breakthroughs in visualization came in with VR and since late 2015, India is going crazy about VR. Other than the direct purchase of VR headsets/ Google cardboards by the end consumer, businesses getting into promotional distribution of Google cardboards for VR based brand promotion is working as a critical catalyst for VR adoption."



VR is being used even to simulate war and flight trainings

The architecture and real estate sector has seen a lot of traction when it comes to using VR for commercial purposes. Increasingly, real estate developers are using VR walkthroughs of planned projects to present it to their potential clientele. This definitely saves them the cost of maintaining a brick and mortar demonstration house/flat. Simultaneously, it increases the range of potential buyers to a much larger area.

Another strong potential market is education, which is already picking up fast in terms of VR and AR content creation. There are apps that work with your smartphone on the Google Cardboard or similar headsets to provide educational content to students of all ages. Advertising and product demonstration in general have also shown a lot of interest in implementing VR and AR. SpectraVR, an Indian VR startup, has worked with the likes of Mercedes, Maruti, Kingfisher, Wonderla, Shahrukh Khan among others to create promotional VR content.

The Rewards

Both VR and AR are at a very nascent stage to actually have an observable remuneration trend. It is more dependent on the kind of work that is being done at the particular company where you want to work. A company that is using VR as a promotional tool is less likely to pay a developer any different as compared to a

IT professionals are being paid. For example, a good VR developer having less than three years of experience could easily draw a compensation of approx. 8-10 lacs INR.

In Conclusion

Whether you chose VR/AR as a career option because of the growing demand or because you are passionate about creating a world of your own in any form, industry initiatives will always be a big boost to your goals. And it is good to know that there are actually quite a few Indian companies working on that. GreyKernel is running a 'VR Developers' community to bring all VR enthusiasts on one platform. "We organize workshops/meetups in institutions to spread awareness as well as kickstarter knowledge packs in the form of free resources and learning sessions for enthusiasts to get into VR development", says Mr. Abhishek Gupta.

Meraki VR is another startup that is working on developing a strong developer base for VR and AR by taking sessions on VR in colleges and institutions to create awareness of the medium. "At Meraki, we've used VR to craft unique experiences for marketing, training, sports and entertainment among other areas. While its applications are valuable to a whole lot of industries, is the consumer going to be as excited? When and how will VR go mainstream are questions that remain as the medium will continue to metamorphose to accommodate advancements in AR and Mixed Reality", says Mr. Sairam Sagiraju, Creative Director, Meraki.

Think about it. Now, you have the roleplay set, the training right in front of you, the armory waiting for your choice, the battlefield ready for your assault and the rewards right there for you to plunder. Grab that VR headset and dive into this game right away! We couldn't help make that game reference on this one. On that note, let's hope that pretty soon we will see a surge of VR and AR content with Indian developers behind them